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Agentic AI for Lead Generation

Partner companies for the Marketing Chair

Tobias Weiß · Guest Lecture · Marketing Chair

Thursday, 22 October 2026 · 15:15–16:00
within "Advanced Issues in Marketing and Sales" (Prof. Haas)

45 minutes · BWL Master students · WS 2026/27 edition

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Why this session exists

- The chair partners with companies: funding, data, cases
- Finding + qualifying partners is manual, slow, unscalable
- Agentic AI can research, score and rank prospects
- **Demo output = evidence for "Sales Strategy and Execution" (SS 2027)**

> Nobody wins from another lecture about chatbots.

[jot: the "ranked list" is the handoff artefact — the "output as input" promise. Protect it; it returns on slides 16/18.]

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What you will be able to do

By the end…	You can…
Understand	Explain what "agentic" means, and why it is not a chatbot
Operate	Read how a harness (pi) gives an AI tools, rules and a task
Assess	Judge an agentic output: checked? citable? repeatable?
Apply	Reuse the loop from the demo (contract → run → verify) for partner sourcing
Context	Say which context an agent can't know — and why that keeps you in charge

> Model = brain. Harness = hands. Workflow = muscles. **Context = memory — the part only you can supply.**

[Not read — colour:] Row 5 is the thread of the whole talk: intelligence is distributed — generation (model), execution (harness), context (you).

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Roadmap — 35 min + 10 min Q&A

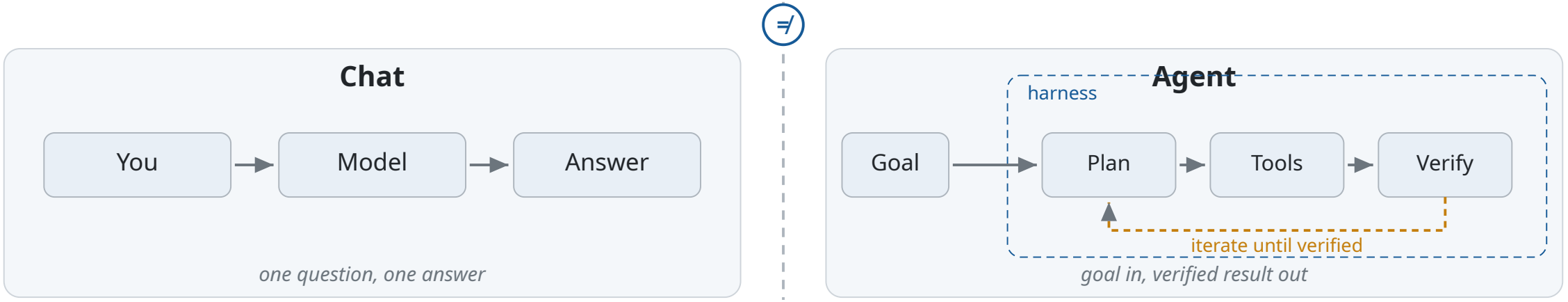
Block	Content	Time
1 · Foundations	agentic ≠ chat · model · harness · loop	~8 min
2 · Method	contracts · the lead-gen loop · sector decision · evidence	~7 min
3 · Walkthrough	live demo: contract → agent → verify	~13 min
4 · Reflection	providers · take-aways · resources	~5 min
5 · Q&A	your questions · discussion	10 min

> The walkthrough is the heart — theory is fuel for it. **10 minutes are reserved for your questions.**

[Not read:] The notes sum to ~32 min; the gap to 35 is deliberate buffer for transitions and demo hiccups. Q&A is fixed at 10 min — bank questions with "hold that for Q&A".

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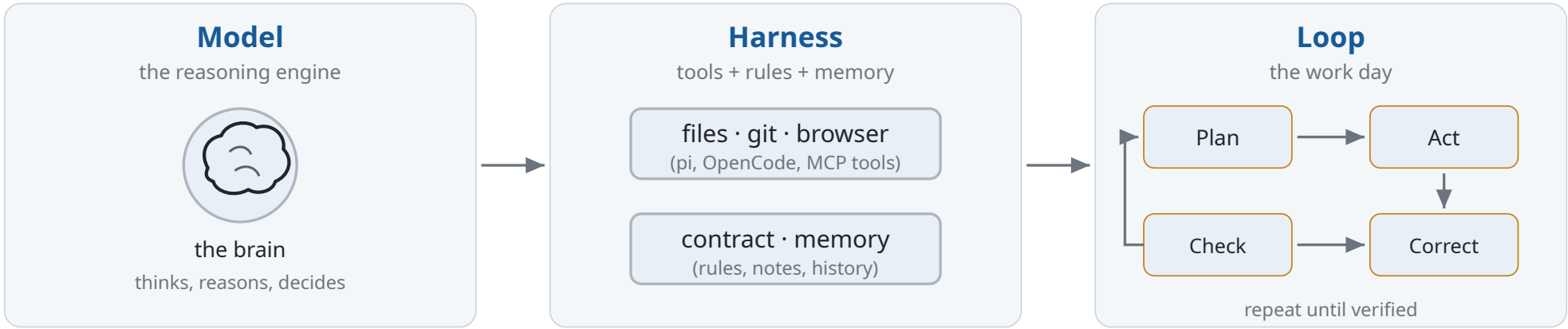
Agentic ≠ chat



> "Agentic" is a working environment — not a better chat.

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The parts: model · harness · loop



Harnesses (2026): pi, OpenCode, Claude Code — same model, different results. The harness decides.

(Disclosure: pi is my own project.)

[Not read:] If asked later — pi default is memory footprint, not "my software is better"; keep it honest, students test this.

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Why now — the evidence inside the research corpus

The chair's open corpus (marketing-research, public on GitHub): **13,096 papers — 7,771 published in 2026 alone**

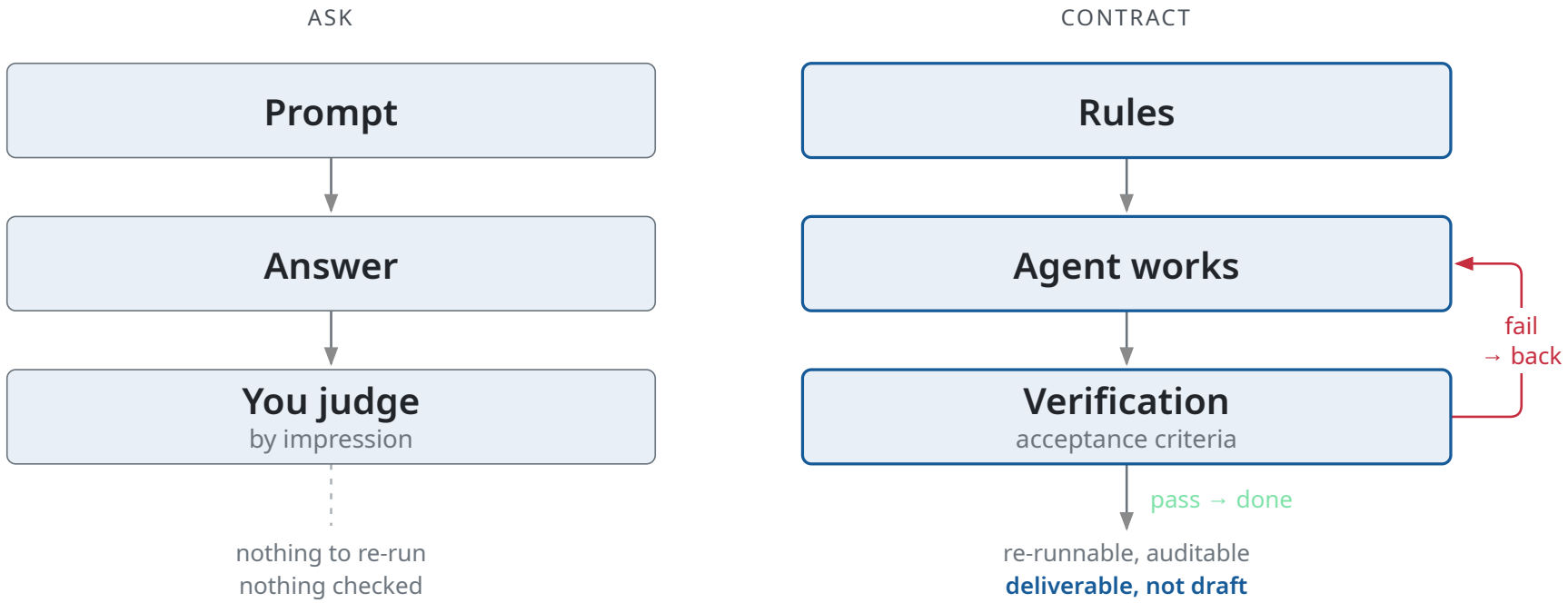
Signal	Count
Papers mentioning **agentic AI**	91
Papers on **lead generation**	27
Both (agentic × lead-gen)	**0**
Papers on **context-aware** marketing	22

> Context-aware marketing exists. Agentic lead generation doesn't. Nobody connects the two yet.

[Not read — honesty note if probed:] Counts come from keyword search over title/abstract of our own corpus — a heuristic, not a citation index — but conservative; the gap is real and wide.

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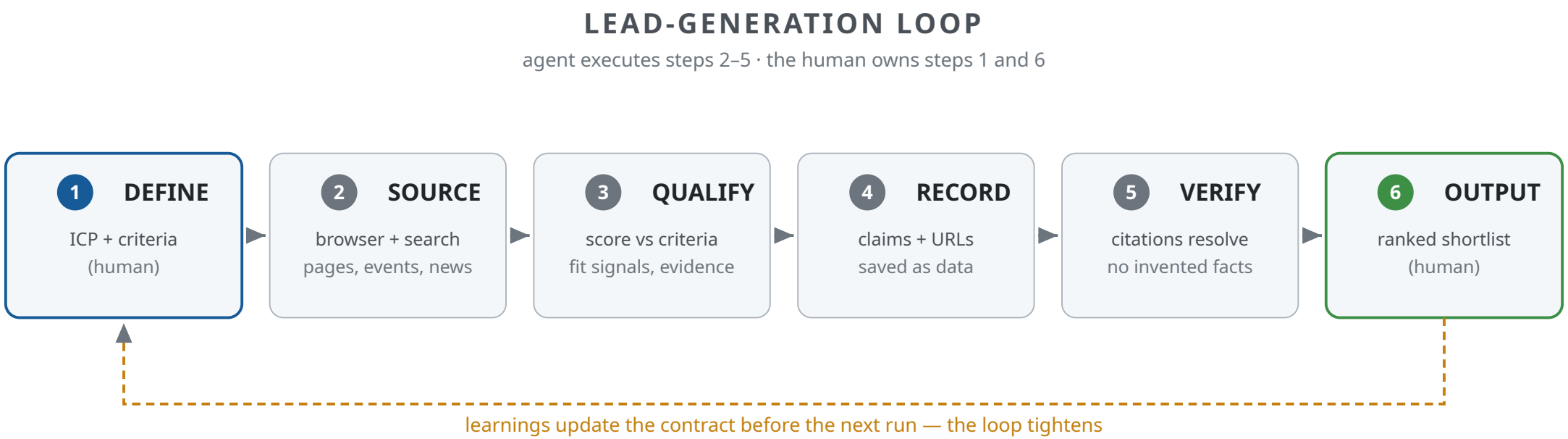
How to talk to the machine: prompts vs contracts



Prompt = asks a chat · Contract = runs an agent · **Context = what the machine can't know**

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A lead-generation loop as an agentic workflow



> Six steps — the agent executes 2–5, you own definition and evaluation. **Those two boxes are where context lives.**

[Not read:] DEFINE injects context (criteria, sector, guard rails); EVALUATE judges with context (the three questions). Next slide makes

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Define the hunt: scoring the sector

Lead generation starts with a **human** decision: *which sector do we hunt?*

Criterion (1–5)	Mech. & plant engineering	Optics / photonics	Grocery retail
Chair research fit — sales management	5	5	2
Course fit — "Sales Strategy and Execution"	5	5	2
Regional employers (Mittelhessen)	5	5	3
Lead-gen relevance — B2B, long cycles	5	4	2
Demo data availability	4	4	5
Total	**24**	**23**	**14**

> Hard guard: sector is out if chair fit < 4 **or** lead-gen relevance < 4 — grocery retail (our first default) fails.
> **Decision: German mechanical & plant engineering.**

[Not read:] This is the DEFINE box made concrete; guards the claim the walkthrough is human-steered, not agent-chosen.

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Now: a live walkthrough

Task: build the **partner-candidate shortlist** — top 10 B2B companies (live today: 2 of them) with:

- Fit signal per company vs. the chair's partnership goals
- Named source URL per claim (citable, verifiable)
- Ranked output — evidence base for the Bachelor course "Sales Strategy and Execution"

I run this live in a harness — what you see is what the agent does.

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Walkthrough · Step 1 — The contract

```
AGENTS.md / brief (what the agent reads at start)
Goal:      shortlist of 10 B2B partner candidates for the chair
Criteria:  industry fit, innovation agenda, university links
Sources:   company sites, press, funding registries
Output:    ranked list, every claim with a URL
Rules:     no invented facts; if unsure, mark as unverified
```

> Done means: verified, cited, repeatable.

[Not read:] The live file is lecture/demo/AGENTS.md; full kickoff prompt + narration: lecture/demo/demo-script.md.

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Walkthrough · Step 2 — The agent at work

Watch the six-step loop run live:

- **only watch** — no magic, every tick is visible in the terminal
- agent **opens the browser** (MCP), reads real company pages
- scores against **the contract** → markdown table with **URLs**
- **iterates**: pause, correct, re-check — that is the loop

> Nothing happens off-screen — the loop is fully visible.

[Not read:] Steps: (1) open browser via MCP, search prospects;
(2) read real pages, extract fit signals; (3) score vs contract;
(4) write markdown table with URLs; (5) re-check citations;
(6) ranked list. Speed beats completeness — cut company two if running long. Demo runs on real public data via cloud API — never paste private/customer data. Fallback: no network → play

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Walkthrough · Step 3 — The three questions

1. **Checked?** Did the agent verify its output, not just generate it?
2. **Citable?** Does every claim have a URL that resolves — and actually supports it?
3. **Repeatable?** Same contract → same method → a result you can re-run and audit?

The 1–5 scores are a transparent heuristic — each criterion with evidence — not a measurement.

> All three guard one thing: **context** — invented context (Checked) · untraceable context (Citable) · lost context (Repeatable).

> The final slide of the walkthrough: apply them to the live result.

[Not read:] Repeatability is process-level, not byte-identical output — models are stochastic, the method is re-runnable. Sales connection: you verify a prospect's claims before signing.

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What you just saw

1. A contract (rules) — not a prompt
2. An agent doing the loop: plan → act → check → correct
3. A verifiable artefact — the ranked shortlist
4. **Context — supplied by you, enforced by the contract, checked by the loop**

That is the method — reusable for any partner-sourcing task.

[Not read:] Point to resources slide for how to start trying it yourself.

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What the chair gets out of it

- A reproducible partner-sourcing method (not a one-off search)
- A ranked, sourced shortlist — usable immediately
- Students who can run agentic workflows (a real skill for the CV)
- Evidence base for the **Bachelor course "Sales Strategy and Execution"** (SS 2027)

> The lecture is not the output. The shortlist is.

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Key AI providers — what you can use as a student

Provider / offer	What you get	Where
JLU HRZ API-Service ★	LLMs for all JLU members: free local Qwen models (256K–1M ctx) + commercial, works with OpenCode / Claude Code	uni-giessen.de → HRZ → KI → API-Service · access via **ki@uni-giessen.de**
Google AI student plan	1 year Google AI **Plus** free · Gemini, higher limits, 400 GB	one.google.com/ai-student — verify via SheerID (student status)
OpenRouter	one API key → many models (OpenAI, Anthropic, Google, open) · free models + pay-as-you-go	openrouter.ai
Harnesses	the tools from today's demo — **OpenCode**, pi *(full disclosure: pi is my own project)* — work with any key above	opencode.ai · pi.dev
Local models (Ollama)	free, run on your own laptop, no account, private	ollama.com

> Start with **HRZ API**: free for JLU members · Google deal expires **Dec 31, 2026**.

[Not read — for questions:] Google deal redeem by Dec 31 2026, SheerID verification; OpenCode via LiteLLM provider block (baseURL api.hrz.uni-giessen.de) or Claude Code via

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Take-aways

1. Agentic = working environment, not a chatbot
2. Harness = model + tools + rules = accountable AI work
3. Contract first: define "done" before you start
4. Verify, cite, repeat — the three questions
5. **Context beats compute — the right context contract beats a bigger model**

> Next summer semester: the chair decides what this evidence feeds into the Bachelor course "Sales Strategy and Execution".

[Not read:] Take-away 5 is the portable one-liner; it reframes the lecture beyond today's demo.

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Resources

- **JLU HRZ API-Service** (free LLMs for JLU members) — uni-giessen.de → HRZ → KI → API-Service · model overview
- **HRZ access one-pager** (student quick start, 1 page) — `hrz-access-one-pager.md`
- **pi** — pi.dev · docs: pi.dev/docs *(full disclosure: my own project)* · **OpenCode** — opencode.ai · **OpenRouter** (one key, many models) — openrouter.ai
- **Google AI student plan** — one.google.com/ai-student (1 year free for students)
- **marketing-research** (chair corpus, public) — github.com/tobias-weiss-ai-xr/marketing-research
- **skeleton-research** (forkable corpus skeleton) — github.com/tobias-weiss-ai-xr/skeleton-research
- **This deck** — `lecture/` in this corpus repo (English, 45 min)

[Not read:] Lead with HRZ API-Service (free, university-provided).

Google link repeats the providers slide so it survives sharing.

marketing-research = evidence base of the "why now" slides;

skeleton-research = forkable starter for a student's own curated

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Thank you!

Questions?

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